

Amelia Earhart

American Amelia Earhart (1897–1937) was the first woman to fly across the Atlantic, in 1928. Already a private pilot, she had been invited to join another pilot and mechanic for the flight in a Fokker F7. On that occasion, she was only a passenger, but she still achieved worldwide fame for succeeding where three other women that year had died trying. Later, in May 1932, she would fly solo across the Atlantic, the second person to do so and the first woman to achieve such a feat. The press made comparisons to famous pilot Charles Lindbergh, dubbing her “Lady Lindy.” She did much to deserve the nickname, continuing to build up an impressive list of aerial achievements, and in January 1935 she flew solo over the Pacific from California to Hawaii.

LAST FLIGHT

Earhart continued to break records, and in 1937, as she neared her 40th birthday, she set her sights on one, final challenge—to be the first woman to fly around the world. “I have a feeling that there is just about one more good flight left in my system, and I hope this trip is it,” she said. On June 29, with only 7,000 miles (11,265 km) of the journey left to complete, her goal within reach, Earhart and navigator Fred Noonan set out from Lae, New Guinea, for tiny Howland Island in the Pacific Ocean. They were never seen again.

Earhart waves to fans in Londonderry, Ireland, after flying across the Atlantic from Newfoundland in 1932.

